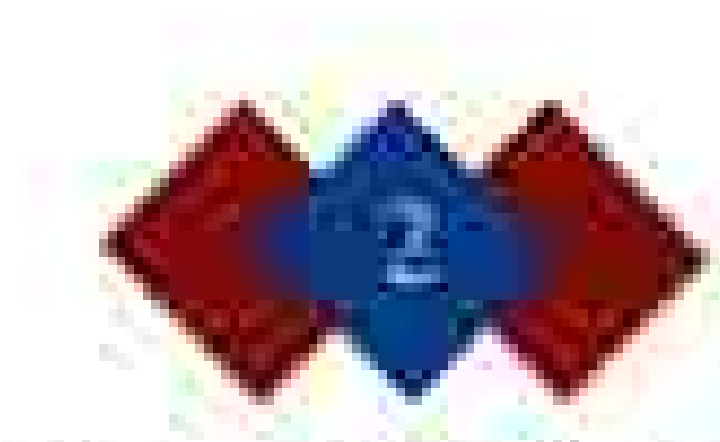




Influencer Revolutions: The Rise of Tiktok Stars and Digital Fame

Alaa Manassra and Rene Ibrahim

Abstract

This research paper will explore the phenomenon of digital fame on TikTok, looking into the background of this platform and how it has reshaped influencer standards and lives. The research paper will give an insight into the lives of social media influencers, the role of TikTok algorithm and how it works, profiling, the monetization pathway for influencers, and the social and psychological impacts of digital fame. Through a theoretical approach, the essay will look at fame, success, and existing theories that explain digital TikTok. Moreover, through empirical approach, the essay will break down the topic into different parts to understand how it works. Findings suggest that fame through TikTok can come with opportunities and challenges, including polarization when posting and negative impacts of mental health, data privacy, and physical health. To sum it up, the essay looks into TikTok to better understand its digital culture and influence here.

Keywords: TikTok, digital fame, theoretical approach, empirical approach, data privacy

Introduction

Have you ever wondered what happened to that fun viral dancing app you used to use? The platform that was a worldwide craze for kids and teenagers, 15 seconds of self-expression and a key to viral fame, posting two weeks ago? Struck by success, this app rose the beginning of the entire generation and influenced culture and values. It can all be traced back to the year 2014 when the app was first launched, promising more than 250 million active users (Microsoft, *Evolution Through Social Media Culture*). This, however, faded against 2017, when it was bought by ByteDance Ltd. On August 2, 2018, it was changed into TikTok (Munro, *For* *success*, p. 2026). By all means, launched an app called Musical.ly, which attracted 100 million users in both China and Thailand. Seeing its potential, they decided to expand it further



and since TikTok has gone a similar way and now more popular in the western world, they thought it was logical to start their app creating TikToks (TikTok).

The social media platform immediately grew in popularity, since it had an appeal to that new generation different from the traditional way. Unlike other platforms where you only post pictures or long videos, you get a lot of fun. TikTok allows you to share short clips that range from 15 to 60 seconds with different parts such as varying effects that make the clips more appealing so that viewers start adding background music that adds a certain vibe.

TikTok's concept revolves around quickly entertaining its audience. With the ability of users to comment on each other's videos and react quickly through their fun creative clips, it didn't take long for TikTok to become its platform all over the world.

TikTok, however, offers unique space to freely express one's ideas as everyone collects. However, because it no longer is very long videos, all you would be a video to get viral and then, all of a sudden, you are the center of social attention, and everyone knows your name. TikTok can be another platform for a person to post as much as he wishes; you could post a video of just talking and if you're lucky, you could be famous. It's a game of luck, either you get viral or you don't.

Adding popularity from a short clip that goes viral allows a person to experience the feeling of being an important figure for a short period of time. It tends to stimulate that someone, the individual would have to become their audience reach by creating engaging, high quality content as well as interacting with other influencers as fast as they need to maintain the reach (Munir, 2021).

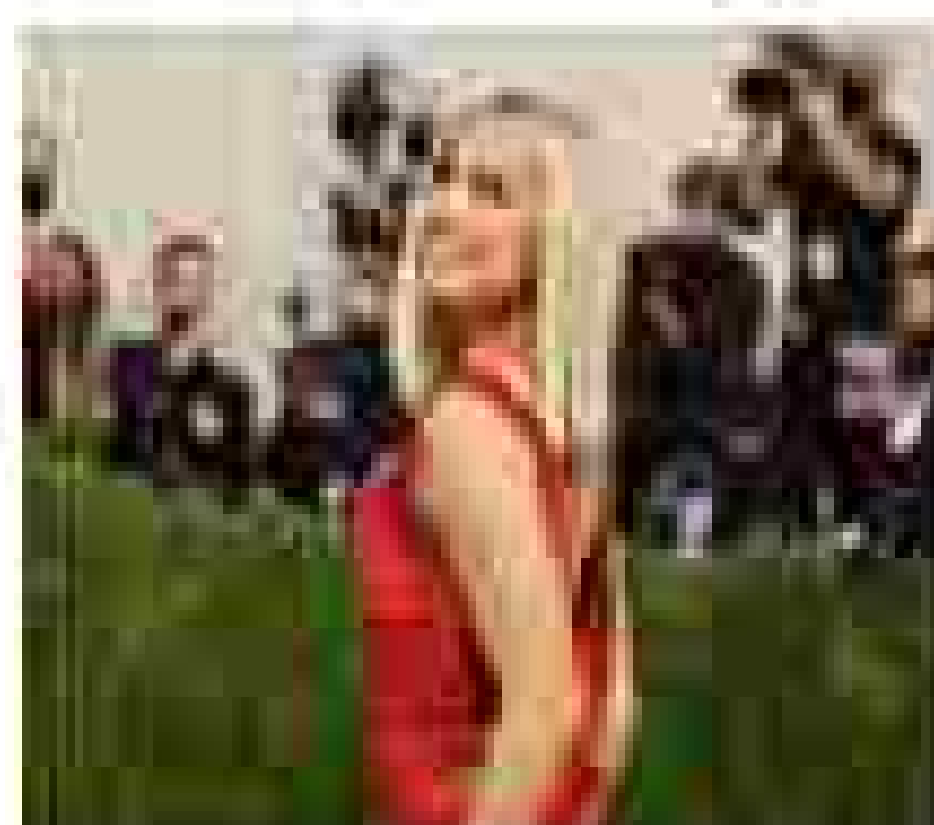
Marketing of TikTok or standard and form:

TikTok has changed the traditional way of marketing as different from the traditional way is to make a brand, as a marketing campaign and competitive process which makes it more challenging for individuals to stand out among the crowd.

Previously, influencers like Emma Chamberlain and Addison Rae were able to rewrite the rules of content, engaging content going viral from mostly colorful content and becoming their being visibility was extremely representative. These other famous collaborations with big name brands and other companies like the Nike Club and companies using TikTok was also a series of creating a household name where power and influence pulled from the digital world into traditional media and popular culture.

However, the profitable pathway that practices these—Influencers and their content—has been disrupted thanks to TikTok's

algorithm which promotes content quality and engagement over follower count. That means that anyone can go viral, but the short period of competing content means that their fame doesn't stand a possibility starting from a low response rate to a determined use of influence which reaching household-name status is increasingly rare. Changing to TikTok, the landscape of content has become so crowded that there is no longer an algorithm even designed to it come out.

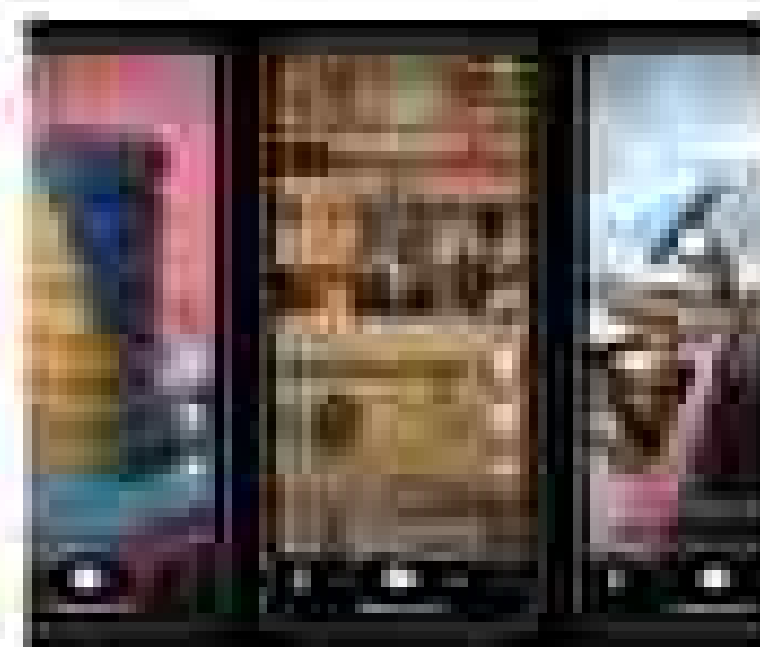


Talia, for example, Sabrina Salerno—who refers to herself as “Talya Girl”—who, in 2012, became a viral sensation due to an epic subway video. She posted nearly a million followers and found death, but she has yet to achieve the mainstream recognition and influence enjoyed. “The number of followers has caused a very noisy atmosphere that is hard to cut through, even if you have millions of followers or potentially 100,000,” said Sengul, a social media expert. Audiences are becoming very skeptical and they seek authenticity and transparency—the otherwise why if a band let one member to change and keep the name going the longer periods of time. There are the days when a viral moment would suffice. Sometimes, being an influencer means one has to “pay the very price” in getting a deep connection with an audience base that also means that their mechanical side of history is hard to turn the past a day (McNabb).

TikTok's algorithm

Several social platforms, such as TikTok, employ algorithms that are designed to engage users by anticipating and displaying content that is most relevant to each user's interests. The algorithms continuously analyze user behavior, engagement data, and other factors to refine recommendations and provide increasingly personalized content (TikTok).

While the user profile is known, TikTok is a social media where users can group the basic concept underlying algorithmic forecasting. The social processes, however, are far more complex. TikTok's algorithm works to deliver content feeds to individual users, providing personalized content via the For You Page. It takes into account user engagement with videos, including likes, shares, comments, watch time, and retention, as well as gathering video metadata such as captions, hashtags, and sound. The For You Page (FYP) is the very first interface that users encounter upon opening TikTok. Significantly, users are right away introduced to a recommended stream of short videos of varying content from different sections of the app, even without following any users. This feature gives TikTok a significant advantage over competitors from the very beginning (Horn).



Each TikTok user's For You Page is unique and tailored specifically to them, meaning that two people will not see the same mix of videos. They need the content on your FYP adapts as the algorithm adjusts to watch your posting history and viewing habits (McNabb).

One way the algorithm works is by a trial-and-error method that determines which videos have the potential to go viral. When a video is uploaded, the algorithm initially shows it to a limited group of users to measure their reactions. The algorithm iterates from this group, starting with the videos based on their engagement (likes, comments, shares) and their completion rates. If the video performs well in this test, it is pushed to a larger audience, increasing its chances of going viral. While less technical, the overall system, location, language, and device settings also factor into factors. With the system, statistics of all users can get distributed by paying attention to creating engaging, high-quality content (Horn).

In a post, TikTok explained that content won't get a boost based on their past performance. This means someone with a large following (even as a history of viral videos) isn't prioritized over smaller accounts with more relevant content (Horn). However, some types of content may be de-ranked, meaning they'll appear less

Instagram) or not at all, on your Timeline Page. This includes videos you've already seen, videos flagged as "spam," deleted video reaction reports off the main clip, and videos with restricted content, like graphic medical procedures. While this type of content may still be accessible if you search for it, it won't automatically show up on your FYP/TikTok.

Effects of digital narcissism

Digital narcissism, according to Michael Plesner, director of social media policy, at the University of Illinois, is "a mental health problem." As stated by Rachel Brown, a psychologist, "There are people who perceive general online identity, that can lead to chronic illness and anxiety." She wished to highlight the way social



media and the non-stop comparisons to present the perfect image and contribute to mental illness (the anxiety and body image issues). Through her own research, Brown aims to persuade others to stop the "never-satisfied, constant" relationship with their own perception of themselves, as well as the pressure that is the product of the often-overlooked competition within

media. Thomas' People who view an Instagram page (or other Instagram or TikTok feed) to receive top quality posts because they are being selected matches. This search for acceptance, which is reflected in the number of likes and comments, some addictive as the perpetually seeking validation and approval from self-validation. Also, according to the article, constant pressure can cause the person to internalize negative self-criticism and negative feelings about their sense of self-worth and value. Such negative self-perception, the authors, will all increased depression and anxiety levels and how they're affected by comparisons of other people's content with theirs. Such issues only highlight a number of ways that digital time affects those social media gladdens from having the purpose of being associated with community, the being connected to the glowing, etc.

FAT's study indicates is a good example of the social media culture on self-image and body perception. Social media platforms like Instagram and TikTok, create unrealistic beauty standards through constant and often heavily filtered content that may foster feelings of inadequacy and self-doubt. This issue is more concerning teenagers and young adults, who compare their own supposedly perfect appearance to high living in the virtual universe.



For instance, a teenager would feel insecure from continuous exposure to pictures of influencers with flawless skin or ideal body types, different to the fact that such images have been modified to look more perfect. Over time this can lead to eating and behavior, mental health challenges such as body dysmorphia.

Facebook, as expressed in the New York Times, digital time exposure increases the pressure to present a perfect image. When someone is told that you're not a good person, that's a bad thing. For example, social media reported that the pressure from their own followers and friends had made them feel like teenagers and that is because they needed to make content that would fit the standards of what "perfect" content was supposed to be, while constantly being going through with things that appear their values or preferences.

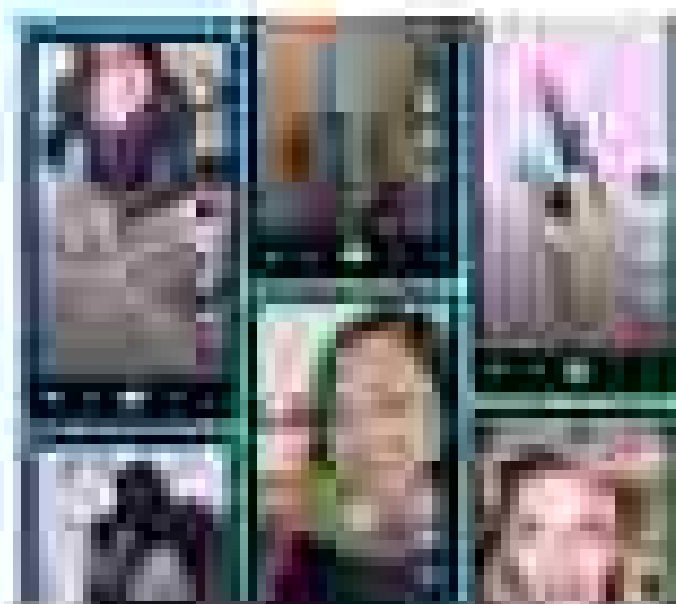
The issue of relative self-perception often hinges on the individual's feeling of isolation, as well as a lack of judgment or negative from online audiences and how absent it is in real life. Throughout the years, the social feelings of imperfection, self-doubt, and loneliness have led up affecting how these individuals view

Opportunities

TikTok has undoubtedly influenced the world of digital media, creating new opportunities for content creators, just as it has opportunities for businesses and brands alike. For them, the platform is full of options – they can be found through the TikTok Creative Fund, as they can take up the opportunity to work with a brand or collaboration through the Creative Challenge. However, there are only noticeable advantages in creating for themselves and getting the potential of a global audience, but they also seem to expand their platform and for marketing up their businesses. As a customer, TikTok has multiplied new features for influencers to create, promote and sell their products on the platform effectively, allowing them to monetize their work in tangible ways, from directly monetizing and innovation.



Business have embraced TikTok for its ability to make campaigns go viral overnight, thanks to its features, creative challenges, and algorithms that work to keep engaging content on the feed. It has given them the greatest power as opportunity to share and share in growing their business on TikTok, sharing their content and ideas, and growing their empire. The description that, TikTok is a cultural hub – a place where people can represent their, have a voice for social issues, and that connects with others who share similar interests.



Most importantly, TikTok has changed the way that of communication itself. Advertising discovery, in a way, has been altered, increased, and amplified for TikTok as a starting point for their content, and viral trends that are trending and constantly growing. It has also become a powerful advertising platform where brands share knowledge related to marketing, fitness, fashion, and business in an interactive manner. With an international reach and wide range of users, TikTok is able to link up individuals and businesses to more strategically advertise, rather than being as well as a transformation from to the digital age.

Social response of digital issues

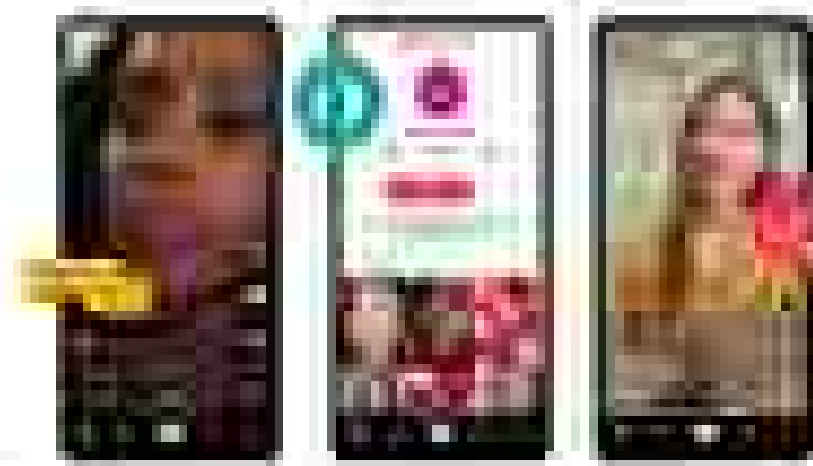
TikTok creates numerous beneficial social effects, such as the formation of communities and the facilitation of cultural and educational exchange. The platform has allowed users to engage in meaningful relationships, readily accessible to users and that change – ultimately serving as a platform for personal growth and empowerment and social transformation. Some of the ways that TikTok has been a force for good for individuals around the world include the following:

Social issues use the app as a powerful tool to spread messages as a long-revered tool to engage with a worldwide audience. The algorithm of the platform allows its content to reach beyond the immediate network of the creator, generating a wide array of social issues movements that



entireties pack. They utilize TikTok as a medium to inform others about significant issues, provide personal experiences, and rally support for a cause. For example, in January, a video for a significant video in the local and global public sphere (Carpenter & King).

Furthermore, TikTok has also influenced the e-commerce sector by incorporating shopping capabilities into its main focus on purchase products directly from the application. This advancement has gained small and



medium enterprises (MMEs) the opportunity to access vast markets without massive marketing budgets. For instance, TikTok Shop offers businesses access to a vast pool of shoppable advertisements and product placements, enabling simple monetization strategies and enhanced sales performance. This development has established a competitive environment between emerging brands and traditional corporations.

Secondly, the app became a necessary when people find the chance to openly discuss mental health problems, share their own stories, and offer support to others who are experiencing the same. This aspect is significant and welcoming for people who are struggling on such help. There are conversations covering stress, feelings, life challenges, and experiences, where people can seek help, coping mechanisms, and a sense of solidarity.

Moreover, TikTok also serves as a broader form of educational content in various subjects like science, history, language learning, and life skills. It offers an interactive platform to engage students, stimulate interest, and fill the gaps in traditional education. This makes learning more accessible and enjoyable, leading users to learn new things and pick up skills in an informal setting.

Although TikTok has some positive social effects, it also possesses some negative effects that need to be tackled. The platform has been accused of spreading misinformation, harmful content, for instance, videos that promote for self-harm, eating disorders, and toxic challenges. Additionally, some features of the app like filters and algorithms also can be utilized for the purpose of cyberbullying. Negative comments, trolling, and harassment are experienced frequently, and they cause emotional damage to the users. The broader patterns of content and the rapidly increasing will give users a bad experience more significant.



There have been recent reports regarding child abuse. TikTok is being used in pedophile and child dangerous profiles, such as pedophile and illegal activities. For instance, some accounts have been promoting a harmful and false weapon, with comments being directed to encourage that groups to buy such items. This not only violates platform rules but also poses extremely serious safety risks (Hernandez, P. et al., 2023). Although TikTok provides a platform for creativity and education, it also poses potential and challenges that have ethical issues in any way. These and possibilities must include impact and address similar safety features or strategies that can help.

Psychological impacts of digital lives

Contrary to the promise that digital lives may seem to have, it can have strong psychological effects. Individuals who suffer of a greater risk of suffering anxiety and depression from internet overuse constantly keeping up the online games, photos, updates and games validation through blue tick status. The compulsive need for digital approval towards one's worth can, therefore, create a sense in which psychological well-being is heavily dependent on the up or down of one's mood and well-being to the reception of those digital rewards (Chaffey 2018).

The constant pursuit of these digital rewards can lead to a state of working condition, potentially causing anxiety and depression when the desired level of engagement isn't achieved.

Moreover, this digital life often comes with a loss of privacy and constant scrutiny. This worrying situation can lead to feelings of vulnerability, isolation, and paranoia, affecting overall mental well-being (Gomez). When relationships may go downhill, as increasingly time-related behavior patterns have been linked to overuse and misuse behavior in personal connections. As the pressure to

maintain an online presence can cause personal connections, leading to feelings of isolation and loneliness.

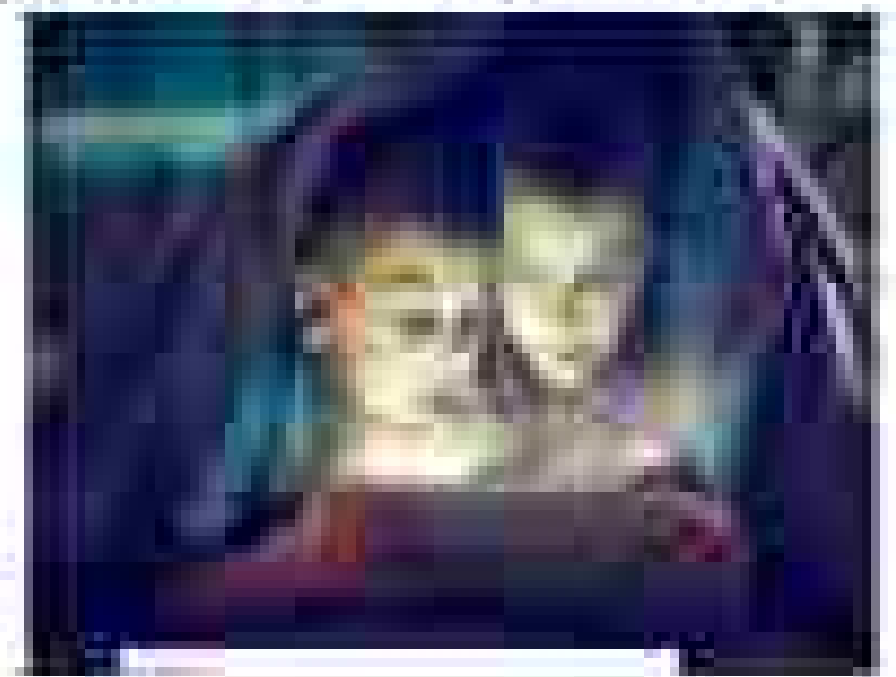
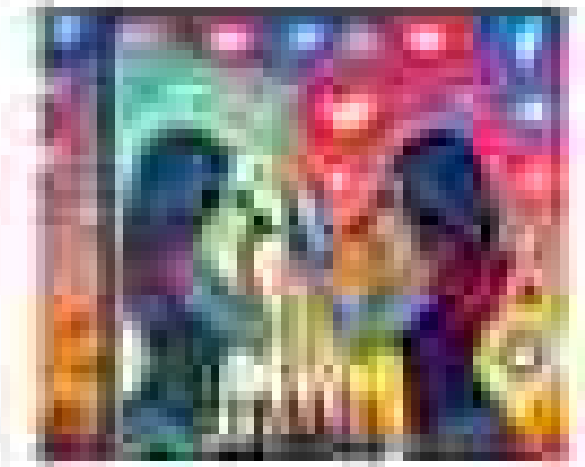
While the negative impact on cognition and behavior can arise due to excessive social media engagement, this is especially true for adolescents and young adults, who may therefore be more vulnerable to comparing themselves to others' efforts and seeking validation from others (Hochschoen).

The constant multitasking required to maintain an online presence can lead to distraction or focusing on false and misleading information that isn't easily verifiable online.

Adolescents and those experiencing digital lives may be a high-risk for mental health issues such as anxiety, depression, and body image concerns (Linda Smith). The pressure to maintain a perfect image and the constant comparison to others can exacerbate these issues. Additionally, the inability to disconnect from their online presence can lead to a blurring of identity between their authentic self and their "virtual" self. All in all, while giving us opportunity, there will be a heavy reputation to keep one's mental space in check and balanced; otherwise, these personal issues in psychological health take some risk.

Conclusion

The rise of TikTok has fundamentally reshaped the social media landscape, introducing a new era of digital lives that promises endless fun, creativity, and rapid content recognition. Although it may seem like many young and tech-savvy individuals are taking to traditional media, the TikTok video content keeps the channel as just another three-day in its digital digestion. The dissemination of influence has led to diverse opportunities for a range of creators from entertainment to marketing and entrepreneurship. However, with new influencers rising high competition, which makes digital lives a game of luck, it is unpredictable and short.



Overall at home

On the social level, influence marketing (IM) has revolutionized the consumer experience, reshaped by brands and influencers. Influencers' marketing has empowered by creators by turning their personal brands to market such products in the late 2000s. The rise was all doing things like virtual live streams, virtual events followed by IMTale influencers tend to their partner brands. Additionally, the platform has provided a space for social activities, allowing users from all backgrounds to reach global audiences and achieve the related goals.

Despite its many advantages, IMTale is still facing many challenges. Technical constraints, such as network and security risks, have been hindering all into a full on the social health of a good number of influencers. The sensitive and sophisticated algorithms have the capacity to a continuous online behavior past the manipulation of trends, making it almost impossible for them to make long-term decisions. Privacy issues, misinformation, and the distribution of abusive content by users have proved to be one of the most real problems hindering.

In summary, IMTale has revolutionized digital marketing for the business realm, offering a brand to find more solid the online exposure but also posing serious difficulties. IMTale is a different form of the digital age due to the sophisticated impact on contemporary culture, business, and community on social media marketing for business.

Overall at home

On the social level, influence marketing (IM) has revolutionized the consumer experience, reshaped by brands and influencers. Influencers' marketing has empowered by creators by turning their personal brands to market such products in the late 2000s. The rise was all doing things like virtual live streams, virtual worlds followed by IMTale influencers tend to their partner brands. Additionally, the platform has provided a space for social activities, allowing users from all backgrounds to reach global audiences and achieve the related aims.

Despite its many advantages, IMTale is still facing many challenges. Technical constraints, such as network and security risks, being technical all into a mix of the social health of a good number of influencers. The sensitive and algorithmic algorithm, from the creation of a continuous online presence, from the manipulation of trends, making it almost impossible for them to make long-term decisions. Privacy issues, misinformation, and the distribution of advertising space by other forms present are just some of the issues still gridding IMTale.

In summary, IMTale has revolutionized digital marketing for the business world, offering a brand that can reach the entire population but also posing serious difficulties. IMTale is a different form of the digital age due to the sophisticated impact of contemporary culture, business, and community on social media marketing for business.